

Morality Among Public Secondary School Principals in Keiyo Marakwet County, Kenya

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his study investigated school principals’ religiosity and moral character in public secondary schools in Keiyo Marakwet County, Kenya. The study was informed by concerns that public secondary schools are experiencing moral and management challenges and lack of integrity among school principals. The study was anchored on the theory by Tony Bush. A cross-sectional survey design was adopted. The target population consisted of principals, teachers, and students of secondary schools in the County. Stratified and simple random sampling were used to select schools, teachers, and student leaders. The study used a questionnaire, interview schedule, and content analysis guide to collect data. From the findings, 46% of the principals sampled were somewhat religious, implying that many were not devout adherents of religious teachings. Principals should meet a minimum requirement in terms of education, experience, religiosity, and moral character. The findings will assist in drafting better policies and practices on the appointment of school principals.

Introduction

This study is grounded in the functionalist perspective of religion. According to **durkheim1995<empty citation>**, religion is a unified system of beliefs and practices that unite people into a single moral community. Religion provides answers to life’s perplexing questions and gives followers a sense of purpose and a framework for living (**lim2012**). In religion, people obtain emotional comfort and are assured that there is a moral purpose to life or even to suffering.

The term *moral* is equivalent to noble, virtuous, ethical, or righteous. Morals are standards of behavior, principles of right or wrong, that enable people to live cooperatively and are accepted by society.

Statement of the Problem

In Kenya, the Boards of Management in public schools often rely on school principals for professional advice.

However, many principals do not provide this information, instead exploiting leadership loopholes for personal gain (**lydia2013**). In many cases, these principals are not appointed based on merit but on other considerations, including political patronage, tribalism, bribery, crisis appointments, and religion (**ministry2016**).

Theoretical Framework

This study is grounded in the Path-Goal Theory of leadership, which posits that a leader’s morality and behavior have a direct impact on the psychological states of subordinates. According to **bush2010<empty citation>**, a leader must possess high moral standing. Effective leadership requires moral engagement, honesty, sincerity, and thoughtful application in management.

Figure Example

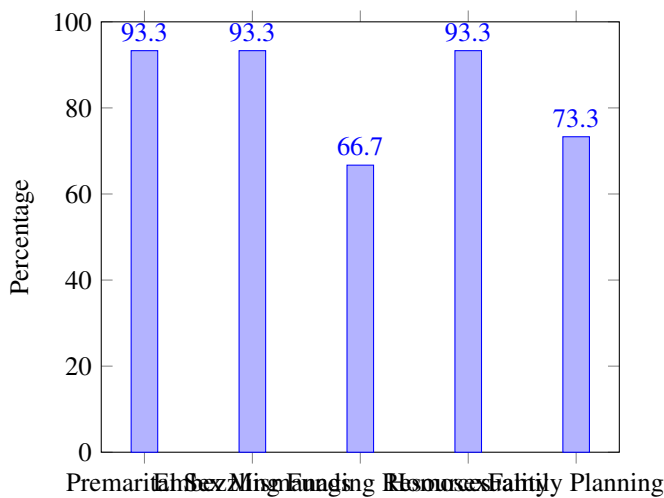


Figure 1

Principals’ Christian Moral Views